

Music and Emotion Experiment Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 20-30 min

Category	The Arts	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	music-and-emotion-experiment

Big idea: Form shapes perception and feeling.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students explore how artistic form shapes perception and emotion.

Student Prompt

Inspect Music and Emotion Experiment Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Music and Emotion Experiment Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: The same image or scene paired with different soundtracks. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Music and Emotion Experiment Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Emotion rating cards before and after the music changes. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Music and Emotion Experiment Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A discussion of whether emotion reveals knowledge or distorts it. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Form shapes perception and feeling.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Music and Emotion Experiment Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Music and Emotion Experiment Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Can emotion be a source of knowledge?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how form shapes perception and feeling.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Can emotion be a source of knowledge?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: The same image or scene paired with different soundtracks.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- The same image or scene paired with different soundtracks.
- Emotion rating cards before and after the music changes.
- A discussion of whether emotion reveals knowledge or distorts it.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/music-and-emotion-experiment/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/music-and-emotion-experiment/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/music-and-emotion-experiment/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Play the silent clip with Soundtrack A. Students write what they think is happening.
2. Repeat with Soundtracks B and C.
3. Students compare changes in perceived story, character and mood.
4. Discuss whether music reveals or manipulates meaning.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Can emotion be a source of knowledge?

- Does art manipulate or reveal?
- How does form affect meaning?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...